

## CAN'T DO IT LIKE ME

[narration: low-mid male voice, modern downtempo militant drill atmosphere, 70 BPM, spoken speech only, completely flat vocal level, no melody, no singing, no sustained notes, dry close-mic delivery, clipped consonants, deliberate pauses]

Can't do it like ME.  
Ain't a BRAG.  
It's a FACT.  
Same BLOCK.  
Same CORNER.  
Same SPOT.  
Same TALK.  
Years kept MOVING.  
You stayed RIGHT THERE.

[music enters: modern downtempo drill, deep sliding 808, sparse dark piano, restrained percussion, tight rim hits, syncopated hats, wide negative space, low-end heavy mix]

[spoken narration: militant anapestic cadence, steady vocal volume, speech rhythm locked to the kick, no melodic phrasing, no singing, hard consonant attacks, short pauses between rhythmic phrases]

Every TIME that I CIRCLE, I NOTICE the PATTERN,  
Same FACES still POSTED, same TALK getting TATTERED.  
Same STORE, same BENCH, same CORNER, same WEATHER,  
Same PEOPLE still STANDING like TIME holds together.  
I LEFT with some QUESTIONS, came BACK with some ANSWERS,  
You STAYED with the SAME ones, just CHANGED up the BANTER.  
You BET that I'd FOLD and come CRAWLING back HOME,  
But I BUILT every MILE while you SAT by the PHONE.  
Twenty YEARS went PAST.  
You STILL where I LEFT you.  
Same DUST on the GROUND.  
Same STORIES that KEPT you.  
You call it a LIFE.  
I call it a LOOP.  
You been GUARDING that SPOT  
while I WALKED through the PROOF.

[speech narration: same low-mid vocal level, tighter rhythmic delivery, no pitch rise, no melodic lift, sparse beat underneath, deliberate silence after each short phrase]

Keep POSTED.

Keep TALKING.  
Keep WATCHING that ROAD.  
Keep COUNTING the MILES  
that you NEVER unloaded.  
I DON'T need your CREDIT.  
I DON'T need your APPLAUSE.  
You stayed WHERE you WERE.  
I kept MOVING because—

[spoken refrain: chest voice, rhythmic speech only, not sung, steady volume, blunt repetition, hard consonants,  
subtle vocal double on final words]

Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
Same SPOT.  
Same TALK.  
Same OLD ENERGY.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
Same CORNER.  
New YEARS.  
Still the SAME routine.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
I got MILES underneath me.  
You got DUST on your FEET.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
You stayed in the SAME SPOT.  
I kept MOVING.

[spoken narration: denser anapestic speech cadence, same vocal loudness, clipped delivery, no shouting, no  
singing, rhythmic triplets underneath the words]

You be THROWING your WORDS from the EDGE of the CURB,  
I be STACKING my DAYS while you STARE and OBSERVE.  
Same LAUGH.  
Same CROWD.  
Same CRACK in the SIDEWALK.  
Same PEOPLE discussing my LIFE when they SIDE-TALK.  
You got STORIES on STORIES 'bout WHO I should BE,

I got YEARS in the MIRROR that ANSWER for ME.  
Never LACED for the HUNGER.  
Never WALKED through the WEATHER.  
Never CARRIED that WEIGHT just to HOLD it TOGETHER.  
You stayed in that CIRCLE and CALLED it your WORLD.  
I stepped OUT that FRAME and let DISTANCE unfurl.  
Now EVERY MILE that I LOG puts a LINE in the PROOF.  
Every NIGHT that I SURVIVE puts more WEIGHT in the TRUTH.  
You ain't LOST your POSITION.  
That's PART of the POINT.  
You been RIGHT where you STARTED. Just OLDER at the JOINT.

[speech narration: low controlled delivery, percussion drops back, voice remains completely steady, no emotional crescendo]

Keep POSTED.  
Keep TALKING.  
Keep WATCHING that ROAD.  
Keep COUNTING the MILES  
that you NEVER unloaded.  
I DON'T need your CREDIT.  
I DON'T need your APPLAUSE.  
You stayed WHERE you WERE.  
I kept MOVING because—

[spoken refrain: rhythmic speech, not singing, same vocal level, hard attack, no melody, no sustained vowels]

Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
Same SPOT.  
Same TALK.  
Same OLD ENERGY.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
Same CORNER.  
New YEARS.  
Still the SAME routine.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
I got MILES underneath me.  
You got DUST on your FEET.  
Can't do it like ME.

NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
You stayed in the SAME SPOT.  
I kept MOVING.

[monologue narration: intimate but hard, flat low-mid speech, no whisper, no melody, sparse piano and distant sub bass, long pauses]

That's the FUNNY part.  
I don't HAVE to say I MOVED.  
The CORNER says it for me.  
Same STORE.  
Same BENCH.  
Same FACES.  
Same TALK.  
Same FUCKING SPOT.

Years kept PASSING.  
You kept POSTING.

I ain't saying I'm BETTER.  
I'm saying I KEPT GOING.

When the ROAD opened...  
I WALKED.

[spoken final refrain: steady militant speech, same vocal level from beginning to end, denser percussion but no vocal increase, no singing, no melodic cadence]Can't do it like ME.

NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
Same SPOT.  
Same TALK.  
Same OLD ENERGY.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
Same CORNER.  
New YEARS.  
Still the SAME routine.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.  
I got MILES underneath me.

You got DUST on your FEET.  
Can't do it like ME.  
NO.  
Can't do it like ME.

Same MAN.  
New MILES.  
Same CODE.  
Different LIFE.

You stayed RIGHT THERE.

I kept MOVING.